

Jeta Amata's *Black November* Response To The Niger Delta Question

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Abstract

Through many decades, the Niger Delta region of Nigeria has been on the spotlight both locally and beyond for reasons surrounding the harnessing and mismanagement of huge natural resources in the area. Even with the extent of scholarly attention on the subject, there is a critical need to assess how effectively film has communicated the realities of the Niger Delta struggle and whether it has succeeded in influencing international awareness and action towards resolving the crisis. This paper critically examines the role of Jeta Amata's film, Black November in highlighting the environmental, socio-political, and human rights challenges faced by the Niger Delta region. The study explores the film's impact as a tool for advocacy and cultural representation, and how it raises awareness about the detrimental effects of crude oil exploration by multinational corporations and the Nigerian government's involvement in the issue. To give depth theoretically, Marxist Theory and Post-Colonial Theory serve the study. Through qualitative analysis, the research investigates the film's role in empowering the Niger Delta community, and its contribution to global conversations on environmental justice and corporate accountability. The findings reveal that Black November serves as a significant platform for articulating the Niger Delta's struggles, emphasizing the importance of resistance, activism, and international cooperation in addressing the region's exploitation. The study concludes that the film has played a crucial role in elevating the Niger Delta's plight to a global audience, fostering empathy, and encouraging advocacy for long-term, sustainable solutions. The research recommends continued media engagement, stronger corporate and governmental accountability, and sustained local activism as necessary steps toward achieving environmental and social justice in the Niger Delta.

Keywords: Niger Delta, Crude Oil, Drama, Film

Introduction

Nigeria have often been described as a rich country owing to her many natural resources bearing massive revenue potentials. However, even with Nigeria's numerous resources, crude oil found in the Niger Delta region has remained the country's economic mainstay for the past four decades. Since the discovery of crude oil in the Niger Delta, successive governments have exploited the region as if an unprecedented gold mine. Irrespective of the background, the Niger Delta region of Nigeria is remains a paradox of wealth and poverty, prosperity and environmental degradation. While the oil industry has significantly contributed to Nigeria's GDP, Niger Delta communities have suffered excessively from the adverse effects of oil exploration. Extensive oil extraction has led to severe environmental ruin, socio-economic marginalization, and political instability in the region (Aghalino, 21). "The Niger Delta crisis"

thus emanates.

Be that as it may, the Niger Delta crisis has historical roots in the discovery of oil in Oloibiri in 1956, which transformed the region into a focus of global oil extraction. Observably, marginalization is a concept synonymous with Niger Delta. The people clearly feel cheated and sidelined owing to the fact that their communities play host to the country's main economic well (Azunwo & Ebenezer, 94). The benefits of the wealth stemming from the region have largely bypassed the local communities as they are left to bear the brunt of environmental pollution and economic disparity. Recurrent oil spills, gas flaring, and deforestation have contaminated water bodies, destroyed farmlands, and devastated fish populations and aquaculture, thereby, severely impacting the livelihoods of the local people (Ebeku, 8). The degraded environment has also brought about numerous health issues, including respiratory problems and cancer, thus, exacerbating the region's plight (Ite et al., 9). This bleak reality perhaps prompted Azunwo and Ebenezer (42) to question politicians/public office holders in the country who take delight in amassing trillions of naira and millions of dollars to the direction of their private bank accounts whereas the faces of those they represent loom at them in hunger, pain and frustration.

To respond to these issues, local communities alongside activist groups have held various crusades in demand for justice and remediation. The Movement for the Emancipation of the Niger Delta (MEND) and other grassroots organizations have been at the forefront of this struggle, advocating for fair compensation, environmental restoration, and sustainable development (Okonta & Douglas, 14). Their efforts highlight the complex interplay between environmental justice, human rights, and socio-economic development in the Niger Delta. However, the film medium might also have a say in this discourse. Jeta Amata's *Black November* can be viewed as a cultural artifact that brings the Niger Delta crisis to a global audience. The art piece's dramatization of real-life events, complications and struggles, the film wishes to raise awareness and foster a deeper understanding of the complexities of the Niger Delta's situation. Perry holds that:

“Black November” showcases resilience and resistance of the local communities against systemic injustices perpetuated by the government and multinational oil corporations (Perry, 63).

The narrative safely brings to the fore the urgent need to address the root causes of the crisis and to implement sustainable solutions that can uplift the region and its people.

Granted the foregoing, it is safe to say that this study seeks to examine the impact and implications of *Black November* on the Niger Delta struggle. Therefore, through an exploration of the extent by which the film has influenced public perception and advocacy efforts, the study aims to assess and showcase the role of the cinema in shaping socio-political movements and driving change. This study hopes to contribute to the ongoing discourse on the Niger Delta crisis and highlight the importance of narrative in mobilizing support and action for social justice.

Theoretical Framework

This study relies on two theories namely: Marxist Theory and Post-Colonial Theory.

Marxist Theory

The renowned Marxist theory which is rooted in the works of Karl Marx and Friedrich Engels, offers a critical lens for examining socio-economic structures and power relations within society.

Central to Marxist thought is the concept of class struggle, wherein society is divided into two main classes; the bourgeoisie (capitalist class) and the proletariat (working class) (Marx & Engels, 18). This theory critiques the capitalist system for its inherent exploitation and oppression of the working class by the ruling capitalist class who control the means of production (Marx, 7). Additionally, Marx introduced the notion of alienation, where workers are separated from the products of their labour, their own humanity, and their community (Marx, 14). Citing Gramsci, Antonio Gramsci expanded on this thought by discussing ideological control and hegemony, suggesting that dominant ideologies serve to justify and perpetuate exploitation by the ruling class (Gramsci, 54). In a related interest, Lenin extended Marxist theory to the global stage, describing imperialism as the highest form of capitalism, where developed nations exploit the resources and labor of less developed regions (Lenin, 12).

Granted the foregoing provision, applying Marxist theory to the discourse at hand provides a sound framework for analyzing the socio-economic and political dynamics depicted in the focus film. The Niger Delta, rich in oil resources, exemplifies the capitalist exploitation appraised by Marx, with multinational oil companies (bourgeoisie) extracting wealth while local communities (proletariat) suffer from environmental degradation and socio-economic deprivation. Be that as it may, the film *Black November* highlights this exploitation by portraying the stark disparities between the wealth generated by oil and the impoverished conditions of the local population. Marxist theory advances this ideology by contextualizing the resistance movements depicted in the film as part of a broader class struggle against capitalist exploitation. A sound outlook on this critical framework, suffices an inquire into the structural inequalities and power relations that underpin the Niger Delta crisis.

Post-Colonial Theory

Postcolonial theory, emerging from the works of scholars like Edward Said, Gayatri Spivak, and Homi Bhabha, critically examines the lasting impacts of colonialism on former colonies and their people. Central to post-colonial thought is the idea of cultural hegemony, where colonial powers imposed their values, norms, and systems on colonized regions, leading to a persistent legacy of dominance and subjugation even after the end of formal colonial rule (Said, 11). This theory interrogates how colonial discourse constructed the 'Other' and perpetuated stereotypes and power imbalances (Spivak, 8). Post-colonial scholars also emphasize the hybrid nature of postcolonial identities, shaped by the interplay of indigenous and colonial cultures (Bhabha, 14). Moreover, post-colonial theory explores the economic exploitation and environmental degradation in postcolonial contexts, often driven by global capitalist interests that continue to exploit resources and labor in former colonies (Loomba, 6).

Granted the foregoing, per application, the post-colonial theory provides a sound understanding of the socio-political and economic dimensions of the Niger Delta crisis as depicted in the film. The Niger Delta's exploitation by multinational oil companies can be viewed through the lens of

neo-colonialism, where global capitalist forces perpetuate economic and environmental injustices similar to those experienced under colonial rule. The film, *Black November*, highlights these injustices, portraying the ongoing struggle of the Niger Delta communities against systemic exploitation and marginalization. Postcolonial theory helps explore these struggles within the broader framework of historical colonial exploitation and contemporary global capitalism. This theoretical perspective enables the researcher to critically examine how the legacies of colonialism and the dynamics of neo-colonialism influence the Niger Delta crisis. This attempt therefore provides a deeper understanding of the region's challenges and the potential pathways for resistance and change.

Film: A Conceptual Overview

Film ordinarily deals with the screen or refers to moving pictures. A film, also called movie, motion picture, moving picture, theatrical film, or photoplay, is a series of still images that, when shown on a screen creates the illusion of moving images. This creative trick played on the human mind is highly intriguing and entertaining. Like live performance, theatre, and as well as other media, film is highly engaging. According to Harget:

Films entertain, persuade and inspire. Films arouse emotions. Films make you happy when you are sad and sad when you are happy. Films disturb. Sometimes, watching a film becomes painful experience. Films make you weep, cry, laugh etc. Films tremble audience from inside (31).

Although, this medium of entertainment is not life experience like theatre, film unapologetically stimulate some sort of emotional impulse on human so much that audience feel deeply involved when seated in front of the TV set. This is as a matter of fact one interesting mystery about film that is yet to be unraveled. Robert and Wallis observed that film offers us ways of seeing and feeling that we find deeply gratifying. They take us through experience. The experiences are often driven by stories centering on characters we come to care about, but a film might also develop an idea or explore visual qualities or sound textures (Robert & Wallis, 2).

The latter's provision explains why film offer to the audience captivating experience(s). Relatively, given the credit that film deals with human experiences, experiencing film is even more fascinating. Ultimately, film makes a person believe in what is going on in front of his/her eyes. That is the power and magic of the film medium. According to *Collins Dictionary*: "Film consist of moving pictures that have been recorded so that they can be shown at the cinema or on television, a film tells a story, or shows a real situation". In line with the above definition, Harget equally describes film as a media that dwells on visual grammar. In Harget's words,

Film is a media and it has its own visual grammar, language and narrative. It is a text that communicates through a visual. It is, the record of communitive event therefore, texts needed to display two characteristics: first, they need to be recorded or recordable, as, for example, a newspaper report, a billboard advertisement, a film, a television program etc. ...second, texts most communicate – in order words, they must generate and exchange meanings (32).

This preoccupation of film relies mainly on the camera which is its basic instrument to tell

stories. Therefore, film narrates, through the use of camera. The camera is the story teller in film but people may want to question “why?” and “how?”. “Why” because there are no other means to communicate through this medium except with the use of camera and “How” because the camera is the capturer and the lens through which viewers see and learn their story. This implies however that, whatever people see on screen is highly dependent on what the camera tells through shots. Shots are like alphabets in film that Makeup beats and beats makes up scenes and the combination of scenes create a story. This process with its deceitful appearance of simplicity requires high creativity from the film makers to effectively transmit an understandable message and story. This is to say keenly that film making is even more complicated than it merely appears. The process requires the creative combination of various elements to create good visual effect.

Film in today's world is a growing industry with more and more developmental complexities and innovations. Given this instance, people of the younger generation may not even be bothered of the history of this art. Even so, film started with the days of static pictures, before moving to silent pictures, and then black and white to coloured pictures and today, “High Definition” pictures. While the technologies in filming improves day by day, it is of importance to state that there are other artistic elements that function effectively to ensure the enhancement and embellishment of the visual effects seen and felt daily on screen.

One apparent imprint deducible from the foregoing provision is simply that film is a collaborative art. It is a long-established fact that in a film production, whether a piece of work is set in the present, the past, in a distant location, or in an imaginary time and place, the film director, screenwriter, composer, actors, costume designer, makeup artist, cinematographer, and production designer combine their skills to tell the story. It therefore becomes a meagre argument when one says film is not a collaborative art. Be that as it may, counting the aforementioned artistic collaborators, film making processes requires the efforts of other backroom staff (crew members) like the location manager, continuity manager, gaffer, audio engineer, electrician, set dresser, camera operator, casting director, ward-rope supervisor, boom operator etcetera. However, whereas it has been well established that film relies on teamwork, economically, film is a source of employment as it avails to artistes and other experts a platform to be expressive with their skills and talents and consequently earn a living.

It is important to note that the impact of film in the society goes beyond its economic contributions. Hence, even though film in recent years is gaining an expanded presence in the GDP of many nations, the social impacts of film reach as far as informing, educating, conscientizing and edifying the public whilst entertaining them. According to Mbe, cinema has become a powerful vehicle for culture, education, leisure and propaganda (Mbe, 91). Explaining the depth of the statement, the latter captures a 1963 report for the United Nations Educational Scientific and Cultural Organization looking at Indian Cinema and Culture, in the report, the author quoted a speech by the then Prime Minister Nehru who stated, “...the influence in India of films is greater than newspapers and books combined.” Bearing in mind that India is a nation with huge human population, the report quickly implies that film has since been a powerful mass media in the society.

Conservative idea suggest that the impact of film is increasingly felt in the society. As implied already, aside entertaining, film can particularly be utilized for leisure whilst communicating

ideas and influencing thoughts. In leading this thought, in a particularly research, Mbe study suggests that the unique properties of attending the cinema can have enormous positive effects on mental health. Specifically, Mbe observe that:

“Cinema attendance can have independent and robust effects on mental wellbeing because visual stimulation can queue a range of emotions and the collective experience of these emotions through the cinema provides a safe environment in which to experience roles and emotions, we might not otherwise be free to experience” (Mbe, 88).

Given this instance, film therefore offer benefits beyond mere visual stimulation. No wonder, film and/or cinematic experience is viewed as exceptional in that it is a highly accessible and accommodative social art form whereby participation cuts across economic lines. Ultimately, cinematic experience can be viewed in the context of a personal expressive experience, leisure and fun, meanwhile therapeutic as well.

Film in Niger Delta

The Niger Delta is the delta of the Niger River sitting directly on the Gulf of Guinea on the Atlantic Ocean in Nigeria (Hogan, 23). This rich terrain is located within nine coastal southern Nigerian states, which include: Rivers State, Bayelsa State, Delta State, Akwa Ibom State, Cross River State and Edo State, all six states from the South-South geopolitical zone, one state (Ondo) from South West geopolitical zone and two states, Abia and Imo, from South East geopolitical zone. In Akpan's opinion:

The Niger Delta is a very densely populated region sometimes called the Oil Rivers because it was once a major producer of palm oil. As a matter of fact, the area was the British Oil Rivers Protectorate from 1885 until 1893, when it was expanded and became the Niger Coast Protectorate (Akpan, 11).

Stating its demographics, a CRS Report for Congress, Nigeria: Current Issues, has it that some 31 million people of more than 40 ethnic groups including the Ukwuani people, Abua, Bini, Ohaji/Egbema, Itsekiri, Efik, Esan, Ibibio, Annang, Oron, Ijaw, Igbo, Isoko, Urhobo, Kalabari, Yoruba, Okrika, Ogoni, Ogba–Egbema–Ndoni, Epie-Atissa people and Obolo people, are among the inhabitants of the Niger Delta, speaking about 250 different dialects. Language groups spoken in the Niger Delta include the Ijaw languages, Ibibio-Efik languages, Igboid languages, Itsekiri language, Central Delta languages, Edoid languages, and Yoruboid Languages. Adding depth to its background, Aghalino is of course not wrong in his submission that:

The Niger Delta area is a petroleum-rich region and has been the center of international concern over pollution that has resulted principally from major oil spills of multinational corporations of the petroleum industry (Aghalino, 5).

The Niger Delta region is equally known for its rich cultural heritage, environmental challenges, and socio-political issues. However, as with many renown regions in the general society, films have always been found engaging in social commentaries about issues affecting the Niger Delta including: the good, the bad and the ugly. However, stating in specifics, film can play a crucial

role in capturing and addressing the complexities of the Niger Delta, shedding light on its unique issues and promoting positive change. Counting the fact that the Niger Delta is blessed with the richness of crude oil thus, responsible for at least eighty percent (80%) of Nigeria's gross earning annually, the region is since plagued with serious environmental issues. Ite et al. notes that:

Activities associated with petroleum exploration, development and production operations have local detrimental and significant impacts on the atmosphere, soils and sediments, surface and groundwater, marine environment, biological diversity and sustainability of terrestrial ecosystems in the Niger Delta (Ite et al., 19).

Discharges of petroleum hydrocarbon and petroleum-derived waste streams have caused environmental pollution, adverse human health effects, detrimental impact on regional economy, socioeconomic problems and degradation of host communities in the oil-producing states in the Niger Delta region. In the basic sense of it, the cliché that pollution emanating from oil exploration in the Niger Delta has polluted the region has given credence to a wide-range of discussions about the area. Thus, excusing other modes, film has since been adopted in the telling of stories particular of the Niger Delta. The Niger Delta story has been telling in films like: Jeta Amata's *Black November* (2012), Jeta Amata's *Black Gold* (2011), Ossy Okeke's *Liquid Black Gold* (2008), Curtis Graham's *Oloibiri* (2016), Ilse Van Lamoen's *Daughters of the Niger Delta* (2012), Sandy Cioffi's *Sweet Crude* (2009), David Attwood's *Blood and Oil* (2010).

In a recent study entitled: “Nollywood and the Niger Delta conflict – media in an advisory capacity,” Ugochukwu's confirms the severity of the damage caused by oil exploration and exploitation in the Niger Delta and justifies the filmmakers who had the courage to produce films like *Black November* (2012) and *Oloibiri* (2016). Similarly, the latter highlights some major achievements the films have reached:

1. They complement each other in building a strong case for the regeneration of the Niger Delta, focusing on the same problems from opposite angles to arrive at the same conclusions.
2. They capture the main issues facing the Niger Delta: a difficult historical background, a growing environmental pollution, the involvement of the West in national affairs, the difficulty of intercultural dialogue between stakeholders, the collusion between the federal Government and Western companies, the link between politics, economy and social deprivation, between poverty, wrong money management and corruption.
3. They have proved that it is possible to screen national and regional issues, no matter how difficult they are, and get the public's attention.
4. The co-productions have raised an international awareness of an oil pollution hitherto ignored by international opinion.
5. They also proved that successive Nigerian governments have reached a stage in which they are stable enough to approve the screening of national issues.
6. The budgets gathered prove that great causes will always be supported (Ugochukwu, 138).

Analysis of Jeta Amata's *Black November*

Synopsis

Jeta Amata's *Black November* explores the complex socio-political issues surrounding the Niger Delta region of Nigeria. The film is a touching exploration of the environmental devastation, human rights abuses, and political corruption that have plagued the region due to the exploitation of its oil resources by multinational corporations.

The story centers on Ebieri Perema, a young woman from a small village in the Niger Delta, who becomes a passionate activist after witnessing the catastrophic effects of oil spills and pollution on her community. The villagers suffer from health problems, loss of livelihoods, and a deteriorating environment, while the government and oil companies remain indifferent to their plight. Ebieri's efforts to bring justice to her people and stop the destruction of her homeland lead her into a dangerous confrontation with powerful forces, including corrupt politicians and oil industry tycoons.

The film shifts between the Niger Delta and the United States, where a group of American oil executives is taken hostage by militants fighting for their rights in the Delta. *Black November* features an ensemble cast that includes both Nigerian and Hollywood actors, such as Kim Basinger, Mickey Rourke, Anne Heche, and Akon, alongside a number of Nollywood stars. The film is notable for its raw depiction of the violence and desperation in the region, as well as its strong message of resistance and the fight for justice.

Delineating Ebieri Perema's (Mbong Amata) Character

Ebieri Perema is the protagonist of *Black November*. Her role serves as the emotional and moral agent of the film. Ebieri is a young woman from a small village in the Niger Delta who evolves from an ordinary citizen into a fervent activist fighting for the rights of her people. Ebieri is characterized by her deep connection to her homeland, her courage, and her unwavering commitment to justice. The turning point in her life occurs when an oil spill devastates her village, resulting in the death of her brother and the destruction of their way of life. This personal tragedy ignites her sense of purpose and propels her into activism.

Ebieri's character represents the resilience and strength of the Niger Delta people in the face of overwhelming adversity. Her journey from a grieving sister to a leading figure in the fight against environmental and human rights abuses is marked by both personal sacrifice and immense courage. Throughout the film, she becomes a symbol of resistance, embodying the struggle for justice and environmental preservation. Despite facing threats, imprisonment, and the loss of her loved ones, Ebieri remains steadfast, illustrating her indomitable spirit. Her character's arc is a powerful commentary on the impact of systemic oppression on individuals and communities, as well as the potential for grassroots activism to challenge entrenched power structures.

Generic Classification

Jeta Amata's *Black November* falls within the category of political drama, with strong elements of social activism and historical fiction. Given this instance, the film explores the complex and

often inhuman realities of life in the Niger Delta. The film examines the political dynamics between the local communities, the Nigerian government, and multinational oil corporations. Expressly, the film highlights issues such as corruption, exploitation, and the systemic oppression of marginalized communities. Through its characters and plot, the film critiques the power structures that perpetuate inequality and environmental degradation.

Themes

Prevalent themes in Jeta Amata's *Black November* will be highlighted as follows.

Environmental Degradation

A central theme in *Black November* is environmental degradation caused by oil exploitation in the Niger Delta. The film vividly depicts the destruction of the land, rivers, and ecosystem due to unchecked oil spills and gas flaring by multinational corporations. This environmental devastation is shown to have dire consequences for the local communities, who rely on these natural resources for their livelihoods.

Social and Economic Injustice

The film highlights the theme of social and economic injustice, focusing on the disparity between the wealth generated from the Niger Delta's oil resources and the poverty of the local population. While multinational corporations and the Nigerian government profit from the oil, the people of the Niger Delta suffer from environmental damage, lack of basic infrastructure, and economic marginalization.

Resistance and Activism

Resistance and activism are key themes in *Black November*. The film portrays the struggle of the Niger Delta people, particularly through characters like Ebriere, who lead movements against the exploitation of their land. It explores the various forms of resistance, from peaceful protests to more radical actions, highlighting the determination of the local population to fight for their rights and protect their environment.

Corruption and Power

Black November also explores the theme of corruption and the abuse of power. The film depicts how government officials and corporate executives collude to exploit the Niger Delta's resources, often at the expense of the local communities. This corruption is shown to be a significant barrier to achieving justice, as those in power prioritize their own interests over the well-being of the people.

Human Rights and Dignity

Black November emphasizes the theme of human rights and dignity. The film advocates for the recognition and protection of the rights of the Niger Delta people, who face displacement, violence, and oppression. It calls attention to the need for justice and the protection of basic human rights in the face of corporate and governmental abuses.

***Black November* and the Niger Delta**

Jeta Amata's *Black November* is not only a cinematic portrayal of the plight of the Niger Delta but also a powerful piece of social activism targeted at exposing the environmental, social, and political injustices that the people of the region face. Therefore, it becomes necessary to suffice that the film's impact on the Niger Delta community goes beyond its role as a narrative drama. It is a lens through which the complex realities of the region are explored, and it serves as a voice for a marginalized population long silenced by multinational corporations and corrupt governance. This critical appraisal thus brings to limelight the film's influence on the Niger Delta community by addressing its cultural significance, its portrayal of the environmental devastation, its impact on socio-political consciousness, and its role in fostering global advocacy and responsiveness for the region's people.

In conclusion, *Black November* has had a significant and far-reaching impact on the Niger Delta community. The film serves as a cultural and political tool, raising awareness about the environmental devastation and social injustices that the region faces, while also empowering the local population by validating their resistance and cultural identity. Through its global reach, the film has drawn attention to the Niger Delta's plight, fostering international empathy and advocacy for the community's ongoing struggle. Despite some limitations, *Black November* remains a vital work of cultural and environmental advocacy, amplifying the voices of the Niger Delta people and contributing to the broader fight for justice and accountability in the region.

Commendations

First and foremost, to enhance media and film advocacy, it suffices to say that filmmakers and media professionals continue to produce contents that highlights the Niger Delta's environmental, social, and political struggles. This will maintain global awareness and keep the region's issues in the spotlight. Again, future films could explore deeper local narratives and provide a more persuasive portrayals of the complexities involved.

In a related interest, the Niger Delta community should be supported in its efforts to resist environmental and socio-economic exploitation. In this instance, NGOs, civil society, and grassroots movements should collaborate to empower local activists through education, legal aid, and financial resources. Similarly, building local leadership and community-based initiatives will strengthen the region's capacity for self-advocacy.

It is also on course to apprise the opinion that the government and international bodies should enforce stricter regulations on multinational oil companies operating in the Niger Delta to prevent environmental degradation and ensure that companies are held accountable for their actions. This should include pushing for compensations for past environmental damage and demanding corporate transparency in future dealings.

In specific sense, the Nigerian government must play active role in addressing the root causes of the Niger Delta's struggles, including corruption, inequality, and environmental mismanagement. Policy reforms that promote sustainable development, equitable resource distribution, and environmental conservation are crucial for the region's long-term well-being. If this is done, restiveness among youths in the region would see a decline.

Corroboratively, global institutions, including the United Nations and international environmental organizations, should increase diplomatic and economic pressure on both the Nigerian government and oil companies to address the environmental and human rights violations in the Niger Delta. Multinational cooperation and foreign investment should be aligned with sustainable and just practices that benefit local communities.

In a final remark, it suffices to say that continuous educational programs should be developed to clarify Niger Delta youth about environmental sustainability, activism, and their cultural heritage. Raising awareness among the younger generation will ensure that the fight for justice and environmental protection continues.

In conclusion, Jeta Amata's *Black November* highlights the importance of both local and global efforts in addressing the systemic injustices faced by the Niger Delta. Thus, implementing these recommendations will not only foster greater accountability but also help empower the Niger Delta community in its ongoing struggle for environmental and socio-economic justice.

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